

Cracked!

Player-facing; no Ref defense roll, no leftover math.

AC sets a minimum — it does not reduce damage. After Defend, the blow either bounces off or sinks in full.

Remaining Damage vs AC	Result
$\leq$ AC	<i>Tink!</i> — no damage
$>$ AC	Full damage (nothing subtracted)

Always express armor and natural protection in the same human terms:

Kit	AC	<i>Tink</i>	Hurts
Unarmored / soft	0	—	any
Leather	1	1	2+
Gambeson	2	1–2	3+
Chain	3	1–3	4+
Plate	4	1–4	5+
Full plate / harder	5+	1–5+	6+

Fiction is kit when it wears kit: *that orc is in gambeson, mail, plate*. Natural hide/shell uses the same words: skeleton **as leather**, crab **as plate**, dragon **as full plate** or harder. Players may ask.

Poleax Spark: break armor instead of taking the extra action. Resolve that blow at AC 0; that armor gives no AC for the rest of the fight.

Named Resistance (silver, fire...) uses the same binary rule. AC and Resistance never add; use the highest applicable threshold.

Cracked! and Splatted!

Damage through armor comes off HP.

Monster HP	Result
Above 0	Still fighting
0 down to –Max HP	Cracked!
Past –Max HP	Splatted! — dead now

Cracked! No AC. No Resistance. No Fuel refill on Roll Initiative. Keep whatever Fuel remains; spend it if you must. The next damaging hit finishes them — even a 1.

In play, Cracked monsters often whimper off, flee, or surrender. The Ref naturally shifts Fuel and attention to whoever is still standing.

Named or solo foes may use full PC Wounds and Shock instead.